



Report - Meeting in Groningen, 12/01/2018

People attending the meeting:

- Jos (Skype)
- Lingyun
- Lorenzo
- Tom
- Jiri
- Maarten
- Pjotr
- Frans

Main topics discussed:

- Updates regarding the application development
- The participation at the *Visual Data Storytelling Contest* in PacificVIS 2018
- Potentials improvements and innovations to implement
- The next steps

Summary:

At the moment the web application is available and running. It allows manipulating some given 3D data (zooming, rotation, slice manipulation) and the interactions made are recorded and shown in form of provenance graph. However, it is still basic and at an early stage. For this reason, we decided to skip the PacificVIS call.

Then, we discussed how to improve the application and the provenance graph, especially. Three main features should be implemented: 'grouping', 'merging' and 'thumbnail', to show only the relevant nodes, to merge/copy the interactions from one branch to another one and to show a preview of the data related to each node. Other improvements discussed consist of allowing to visualize the neighbors of the selected node while collapsing the other ones, to encode the interaction type and other info related to the nodes (e.g., when some annotations have been made into the graph), to allow the user to pass from 3D view to 2D view by alignment and to make measurements, to create the 'undo', 'undo and mark' and 'hide' functions for dealing with the mistaken user interactions, and to create a 'shift' function to select and merge multiple nodes.

From the research point of view, the next steps are to develop a taxonomy of interactions in visual storytelling to make the grouping and merging feature to be efficient. With the objective to submit a short paper for EuroVis 2018 (the deadline is 2 March). Regarding the software development, the code should be rearranged and restructured before starting with the implementation of the new features.

The next meeting will be during the first/second week of February in Amsterdam and it will be decided soon by a doodle.